Cowabunga

SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

FRI OCT 23, 2026

DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · FRI OCT 23 · NORTH PB

The S swell is still running at 15 seconds, and the wind finally lays down this morning. Little Point on the drain, 10 to quarter past noon.

S groundswell, light wind: paddle out by 10

PADDLE OUT BY

10:00

BOARD

Anvil twin

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	10a–12:15p · Anvil twin · ~73°F
SURF	2–4 ft, sets 5 (SRF), S 15s + W 7–9s windswell
TIDE	L 0.7 @ 1:35a H 5.3 @ 7:53a L 0.7 @ 2:09p H 4.7 @ 8:09p obs 5.4 @ 5:48a

A falling tide on a reef speeds up the wave as the water drains off.

~73°F
WATER

7 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Good — worth rearranging your morning

capped by swell 3.0 ft, 12s period · Better than 30% of 40 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

2-4 FT, SETS 5 (SRF), S 15S + W 7-9S WINDSWELL

GROUND

SwH 2.6–3.3 ft · 12–14s

WINDSWELL

WWH 3.0–3.3 ft · 9s

HS BUOY

Hs 4.6 ft · 46258



FROM

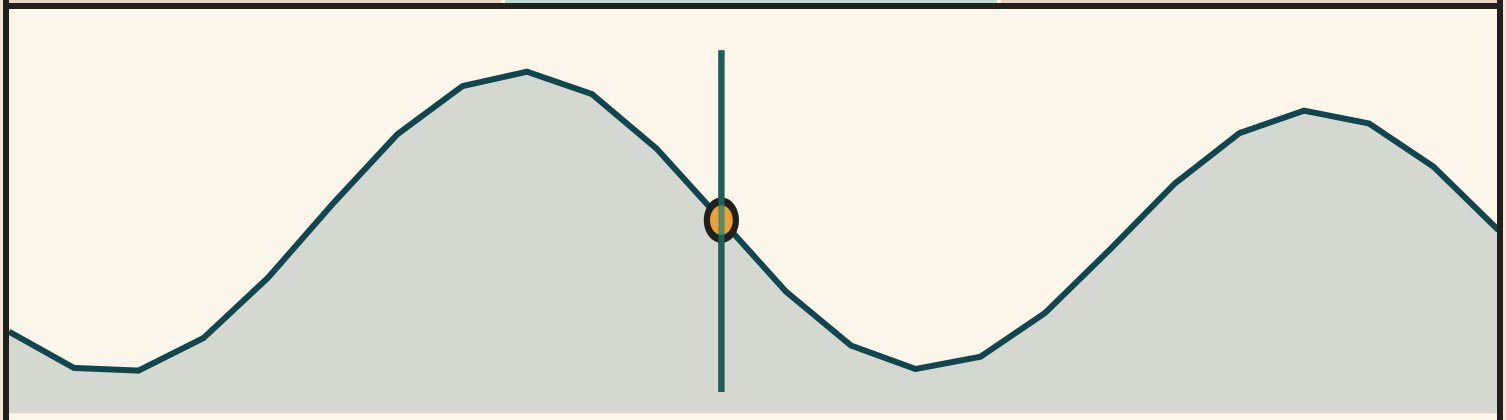
201° SSW

Buoy 46258 · Hs 4.3–4.6 ft @ 13s (spectrum SwH 2.6–3.3 ft @ 12–14s SSW overnight) + WWH 3.0–3.3 ft @ 9s · face 2–4 ft, sets 5 (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 3 ft @ 15s + W 3 ft @ 7s · SwD 201° SSW · wind light SE to S through 10a

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

DAWN–10A · REEF TOO FULL	10A–12:15P · LITTLE POINT, LIGHT WIND	AFTER 12:15P · REEF BELOW FLOOR, NW WIND FROM 2P
WAIT	**GO**	**SKIP**



11:00a	GO · Little Point, light wind	3.0 ft tide	SW ~4 kt · NWS	2–4 ft, sets 5 (SRF), S 15s + W 7–9s windswell

L 0.7 @ 1:35a · H 5.3 @ 7:53a · L 0.7 @ 2:09p · H 4.7 @ 8:09p · obs 5.4 @ 5:48a

Little Point, 10a to about 12:15p, on the Anvil twin. Table tides: H 5.3 @ 7:53a, L 0.7 @ 2:09p, H 4.7 @ 8:09p. The gauge read 5.45 ft at 5:48a against 4.12 predicted, so it is running about 1.3 ft over the table for the fifth day. That puts the reef near 6.6 ft at the high, over the 5.5 ft ceiling, then about 5.4 ft at 10a, 4.3 ft at 11a and 3.2 ft at noon. LJAC1 was E to ESE 4 to 8 kt from 4:24 to 5:18a. NWS hourly has 5 mph SE to S from 6a to 10a, SW 5 at 11a, W 5 at noon, then NW 10 mph from 2p, with a 31% chance of showers through 10a and 21% after. PZZ740 has SE 10 kt becoming W this afternoon, showers likely mainly this morning.

Where it's working

Little Point

★

Top of the scorecard at 0.94. The S groundswell is holding (46258 SwH 0.8–1.0 m, 2.6–3.3 ft, @ 12–14s since 1:26a; 3.0 ft @ 12.5s SSW 201° at 5:26a) with a 3 ft W windswell on top. The big news is the wind: LJAC1 is ESE 7 kt at 5:18a and NWS has 5 mph SE to S through 10a, SW at 11, W at noon, so the reef should be clean for once. The gauge read 5.45 ft at 5:48a against 4.12 predicted, about 1.3 ft over the table again. That puts the reef near 6.6 ft at the 7:53a high, well over the 5.5 ft ceiling, then about 5.4 ft at 10a, 4.3 ft at 11a and 3.2 ft at noon, reaching the 3.0 ft floor around 12:15. Paddle out by 10.

CALL

2

PB Drive

Score 0.82. Light wind helps the sandbar too, and it can handle the full tide. A good backup if the reef is packed.

SOFT

3

Calumet

Score 0.61. Swell angle is right but the gauge is too full for its window. Pass.

SOFT

4

PB north of the pier

Score 0.55. The SSW angle mostly misses the pier wedge.

SOFT

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Skip · Tourmaline (0.45) and PB Point (0.17) are too full on the high gauge, and the Point is undersized. The Cliffs and OB want a real W groundswell; the W energy today is 7–9s windswell. Blacks and Scripps (extended only) would pick up more S, but the light wind is just as good at home, so no reason to drive.

SKIP

BOARD

Anvil twin

~73°F

QUIVER

Anvil twin fish

Waist-to-chest faces with sets to head high. The twin is the punchiest board you own until the new shortboard shows up.

TW log · too much push on the sets for it

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

A falling tide on a reef speeds up the wave as the water drains off.

As the tide drops, the same swell feels the reef sooner and stands up steeper and faster. At the start of the window it will feel soft and fat; by noon it will be quicker and hollower, then too shallow. Take your best waves in the middle of the drain, and keep an eye on the inside rocks as the hour gets late.

SKIP

Little Point before about 10a, while the gauge-adjusted tide sits over the 5.5 ft ceiling, and after about 12:15p, when it drains below the 3.0 ft floor. Calumet, Tourmo and PB Point on a gauge this full. The Cliffs and OB on a short-period W windswell. Any drive north, since home is just as clean.

GOTCHAS

Water quality: showers are likely this morning (PZZ740). If real rain reaches the coast, the county advises staying out for about 72 hours afterward, especially near storm drains and creek mouths. Moderate rip current risk (NWS SRF). Sets to 5 ft with 15-second groupings and long lulls, so watch a full set cycle before paddling out. The reef drains fast after 11; do not get caught on the inside at noon.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL: Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES